Story Board

Low Tide Radio · Exported 19 Oct 2026 · Source: Current Story Board

ACT ONE: THE CALL

Sequence: Static

Scene Card 1
EXT. OPEN SEA - NIGHT (1999)
Prologue. A storm. Fishing boats in the swell and a woman's voice on the radio reading positions.

Scene Card 2
INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - NIGHT (1999)
Mariamma at the transmitter. Young Anjali asleep under the desk. The lights die.

Scene Card 3
INT. SOUNDWAVE STUDIO - BENGALURU - DAY
Present day. Anjali scrubs breaths out of a detergent ad. Fathima calls: Appachan is missing.

Scene Card 4
INT. KSRTC BUS - MOVING - NIGHT
The overnight bus to Kochi. Anjali listens to an old cassette of her mother on air.

Scene Card 5
EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - DAWN
Anjali arrives. Appachan sits at the foot of the mast with his dog Kannan. Inspector Latha waits by her jeep.

Scene Card 6
INT. THOMAS HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY
Tea with Fathima. The Port Trust notice on the fridge: demolition in seven days.

Sequence: Seven Days

Scene Card 7
EXT. KADALKKARA HARBOUR - DAY
Anjali walks the harbour. Fishermen remember her mother. Suresh runs a survey crew and does not want her there.

Scene Card 8
INT. PORT TRUST OFFICE - DAY
Anjali asks for access to the station. The Port Officer refuses. Suresh watches.

Scene Card 9
INT. FATHIMA'S TEA SHOP - NIGHT
The school radio club meets over tea. Rahul asks Anjali to look at their homemade transmitter.

Scene Card 10
INT. THOMAS HOUSE - APPACHAN'S ROOM - NIGHT
In a clear moment Appachan gives Anjali the station keys. He speaks in Malayalam.

Scene Card 11
INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - NIGHT
Anjali and Rahul let themselves in. The tape shelves are empty except for one reel dated 14-11-1999.

Scene Card 12
EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - NIGHT
A security guard spots their torches. They run. Rahul's bicycle chain comes off.

Beat
Tone: the sea before the story. No titles until the static cuts out.

Beat
Inciting incident: Fathima's call. Appachan was found at the station.

Beat
First turn: the reel dated 14-11-1999.

Created with OpenFrame Studio

ACT TWO: THE REEL

Sequence: Oxide

Scene Card 13
INT. FISHERIES SCHOOL - RADIO CLUB ROOM - DAY
Anjali examines the reel. Sticky-shed damage. It has to be baked before it can be played once.

Scene Card 14
INT. FATHIMA'S TEA SHOP - KITCHEN - DAY
They bake the reel in a borrowed bakery convection oven, watched like a newborn.

Scene Card 15
INT. THOMAS HOUSE - VERANDA - DAY
Appachan mistakes Anjali for Mariamma and scolds her for being late for her shift.

Scene Card 16
INT. FISHERIES SCHOOL - RADIO CLUB ROOM - NIGHT
First playback. Static, a laugh, half a sentence in Mariamma's voice. Then the tape stops.

Scene Card 17
INT. JOE'S ROOM ABOVE THE TODDY SHOP - DAY
Anjali visits Joe. He will not talk about that night and asks her to leave.

Scene Card 18
EXT. ST. ANTONY'S CHURCH - DAY
The memorial mass for the men lost in 1999. Suresh reads the names. Anjali stands at the back.

Scene Card 19
INT. POLICE OUTPOST - DAY
Latha warns Anjali about the trespass complaint, then quietly shows her the 1999 file.

Scene Card 20
INT. THOMAS HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
Anjali and Fathima read the file. Fathima talks about her uncle for the first time.

Sequence: Storm Warning

Scene Card 21
EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - DAY
The radio club flies an antenna kite. Anjali teaches them to call the harbour.

Scene Card 22
INT. THOMAS HOUSE - APPACHAN'S ROOM - NIGHT
Appachan's bed is empty. The door is open. Kannan is gone too.

Scene Card 23
EXT. KADALKKARA HARBOUR - NIGHT
The village searches in the storm with torches. Suresh's crew brings the site floodlights.

Scene Card 24
EXT. HARBOUR BREAKWATER - NIGHT
Suresh finds Appachan at the end of the breakwater with Kannan, waving a torch at the sea. He carries him back.

Scene Card 25
INT. TALUK HOSPITAL - WARD - NIGHT
Appachan on a drip. Suresh tells Anjali about his father and the Little Flower.

Scene Card 26
INT. TALUK HOSPITAL - CORRIDOR - DAWN
An uneasy truce. Suresh gives Anjali one day inside the station.

Scene Card 27
INT. COAST RADIO STATION - TAPE ROOM - DAY
In the flooded basement they find the station logbook in a sealed ammunition box.

Scene Card 28
INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - DAY
The logbook: entries stop at 23:40. 'Main power cut by order. J. D'Cruz.'

Beat
Midpoint: Suresh carries Appachan off the breakwater.

Beat
Low point: the logbook names Joe.

Sequence: What Joe Did

Created with OpenFrame Studio

Scene Card 29
EXT. TODDY SHOP - NIGHT
Anjali confronts Joe in front of the drinkers. He walks out to his car.

Scene Card 30
EXT. LIGHTHOUSE ROAD - NIGHT
Joe drives drunk. Latha's jeep pulls him over before the bend.

Scene Card 31
INT. POLICE OUTPOST - CELL - NIGHT
Joe confesses: the Port ordered the power cut. Mariamma kept going on a battery set.

Scene Card 32
INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - NIGHT (1999)
Flashback. In the dark Mariamma connects the battery set. Joe leaves. Young Anjali watches.

Scene Card 33
INT. FISHERIES SCHOOL - RADIO CLUB ROOM - NIGHT
The second half of the reel plays. Mariamma relays positions. Varghese answers.

Scene Card 34
EXT. OPEN SEA - LITTLE FLOWER - NIGHT (1999)
Flashback. Varghese turns the fleet toward the river mouth, then goes back for the Seagull.

ACT THREE: THE BROADCAST

Sequence: Listening Night

Scene Card 35
INT. SURESH'S HOUSE - DAY
Anjali brings Suresh the recording. He listens alone to his father's voice.

Scene Card 36
INT. PORT TRUST OFFICE - DAY
Suresh asks Krishnadas to delay. Refused. He arranges power for one more night instead.

Scene Card 37
EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - DUSK
The village sets up for listening night: speakers, lanterns, a generator truck.

Scene Card 38
INT. THOMAS HOUSE - APPACHAN'S ROOM - DUSK
Appachan dresses in his best shirt and asks where Mariamma is. Anjali tells him gently.

Scene Card 39
EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - NIGHT
Listening night. The reel plays over speakers. Suresh reads the fleet names. Joe stays.

Scene Card 40
EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - ROOF - NIGHT
Rahul and Anjali send the broadcast out from the old mast one last time.

Sequence: Low Tide

Scene Card 41
EXT. COAST RADIO STATION - DAY
Demolition. The excavator bites. The mast comes down. Appachan watches without fear.

Beat
Climax: listening night and the last transmission.

Scene Card 42
INT. FATHIMA'S TEA SHOP - DAY
The radio club paints a sign: Low Tide Radio. Anjali calls Bengaluru and resigns.

Scene Card 43
EXT. KADALKKARA HARBOUR - DAWN
The boats go out. On the radio, Anjali reads the weather.

Scene Card 44
EXT. KADALKKARA BEACH - DAY
Low tide. Anjali and Appachan walk on the wet sand with Kannan. The end.

Created with OpenFrame Studio